



Age is just a number: The 43-year-old Indian, the oldest men's doubles number one, also became the oldest major men's doubles winner at the Australian Open. REUTERS

the next three Tests comfortably. Hopefully, this team will pick themselves up and give their fans plenty of reasons to celebrate.

India certainly didn't help their cause by playing a T20 series with Afghanistan before a marquee Test series like this one against England. Even if bilateral commitments had to be adhered to, those playing in the Tests should have played a Ranji Trophy game or two, for suddenly changing the mindset from a frenetic format to another less rushed one can take

time. The bat speed and the desperation to play a 'get out of jail' shot can and do manifest themselves, as we saw with the dismissals in the first innings. Playing in the Ranji would have given the batters some good practice against domestic Indian spinners.

Sadly, tactical schedule planning is absent, and unless there's a concerted effort to do so, India will keep ending up as the bridesmaid but never the bride, as we have seen over the last few years.



If an individual makes the effort to stay fit and on top of his game as far as preparation, effort, and subsequent recovery protocols are taken care of, then success can be attained at any age.